

2026 Game Rules

- 1) Each game will have 4 – 8-minute quarters. Each quarter will be running time except for certain instances.
- 2) The game ball used for 2nd and 3rd grade boys and girls will be 27.5. The game ball used for 4th/5th Boys and 4th-6th Girls will be 28.5.
- 3) Basket height is 9 feet for 2nd and 3rd grade boys & girls divisions. Basket height is 10 feet for 4th/5th boys & girls divisions.
- 4) The game clock will stop only for shooting fouls, time-outs, injuries, and other emergency situations.
- 5) The game clock will run on any possession change, violations, the ball going out of bounds, etc.
- 6) At the 4-minute mark of each quarter, the game clock will be stopped for substitutions and to allow the players to match up.
- 7) Substitutions can also be made at the following times: between quarters, halftime, any time-out taken by a team, the extra time-out in an overtime game and an on-court injury that requires the player to exit the game
- 8) Each team is allowed two time-outs per half. Time-outs will last one minute. One extra time-out is granted during overtime. Any player or coach may call the time-out.
- 9) **OVERTIME RULES:** A three-minute overtime (running time except for fouls and Time-outs) will be played. If the game is still tied at the end of this time, the game remains a tie.
 - a. **Playoff OT Rules** – If the game is still tied after the three-minute overtime period, we will have sudden death. Start with a jump ball at center court. The first team to score wins. No time on the clock during the sudden death period.
- 10) A jump ball will start the game and overtime. All other quarters will be started with alternate possessions.
- 11) A player is out of the game after six fouls. If a fouled-out player is the last person, the game will continue with that team playing with four players, etc.
- 12) Bonus free throws are shot on the seventh team foul of each half. Players will shoot 1-and-1 free throws until the 10th team foul. At the 10th team foul and beyond, players will shoot two free throws (double bonus)

- 13) Free throw distance is shortened by two feet for 2nd and 3rd grade boys, 2nd and 3rd grade girls and 4th-6th grade girls. 4th-5th grade boy's division will use regulation free throw line. A player's momentum can carry them across the line (does not apply for the 4th-5th grade boys division). Players are allowed to enter the lane once the ball has been released by the free throw shooter.
- 14) 3-point baskets will be counted for the Boys & Girls 4th/5th/6th grade divisions. 3-point baskets will not be counted for 2nd & 3rd grade divisions.**
- 15) Instead of calling a three-second lane violation, we will call a 10 second lane violation.
- 16) Over-and-back violations will be called (both feet & the ball)
- 17) When inbounding the basketball from out of bounds, players will have 5 seconds to inbound the ball back into play. A violation of this will result in the loss of possession to the defending team.
- 18) Each team has 10 seconds to bring the ball over half court
- 19) Any held/jump ball will result in alternating possessions
- 20) There will be running time through all whistles/free throws/subs when the leading team is up by more than 16 points. Once the lead is below 16 points, the clock will resume normal stoppage time.
- 21) No one man spread offense**
- 22) Man-to-man defense only ***(No zone defense allowed)***
- 23) ***2nd & 3rd grade (Boys and girls divisions only)– defensive players are not allowed to steal off the dribble or attempt to steal/tie-up the offensive player if they pick up their dribble. Defense can only steal off the pass. 4th/5th grade divisions are allowed to steal off the dribble, if the offensive player picks up their dribble and/or the pass.***
- 24) Defense should back up 3' from mid-court line, so offense can advance the ball across mid-court
- 25) **No full court press; defense must foul back.** If a team is up by 16 points or more the defense can pick the ball up once it has got past the top of the key.
- 26) Reaching in will be called where contact is made with the player.
- 27) **No double teams are allowed outside the lane.** On a double team call, the first time will result in a warning; on the next violation the person double teaming will be issued a technical, the ball will be taken out at center court and possession awarded to the other team. Scorekeepers will keep track of warnings on score sheet
- 28) Players must keep their distance for the pass-in (3 feet).

- 29) Defensive players who are changing the player they are guarding must say "switch". Switching is only permitted if there is only one defensive player at a time playing the person with the ball.
- 30) Only head coaches, assistant coaches and players are allowed on the team bench during gameplay. Anyone else will be asked to leave the bench.
- 31) Jewelry, earrings, watches, hair clips, etc. **ARE NOT ALLOWED** to be worn during the games. Referees will be checking for these prior to the start of the game.
- 32) All players are expected to receive an equal amount of playing time. Coaches will be on the honor system to ensure that this occurs.
- 33) ***Extreme behavior either directed at a player or the official will result in a technical foul. After the second technical, the person will be ejected from the game. Technical foul is a team foul and is two shots and the ball from out of bounds.***
- 34) ***In the event of disruptive spectators, the first offense is a warning to the coach, the second offense the coach will receive a technical and the spectator will be asked to leave. The third offense, the coach will be asked to leave.***